

#BeTheBetterGuy
A Road Safety Initiative



the ECGC and banks insist that payment through third countries should be part of the agreement when the contract is initiated, that is, before shipment is made. Unfortunately, that provision probably is absent in most contracts.

On March 3, at a meeting in Kolkata, RBI Governor Shaktikanta Das suggested that banks should find alternative ways of handling payments with Russia, but no ideas were forthcoming from bankers. In the past, a rupee-rouble exchange was put in place—this was after the collapse of the Soviet Union, to make payments for defence and other purchases—which may now be reconsidered.

For imports, things may be a little easier. The bulk of Russia's exports to India are oil, gas and coal, all of which, along with agricultural products (like sunflower oil from Ukraine), pharmaceuticals and medical devices, are exempt from sanctions. India's trade volumes with the two countries are not very significant (see *The Export-Import Impact*). The indirect effects, however, are a whole different story.

THE COMMODITIES CONUNDRUM

Over March 7 and 8, the price of nickel on the London Metal Exchange (LME) shot up from roughly \$29,800 to over \$100,000 a tonne, forcing the LME to suspend trading, and launch an investigation into the causes. Russia accounts for 9 per cent of global supply, but influences prices hugely.

The immediate effect of the invasion of Ukraine was the jump in crude oil prices, which traded upwards of \$110 a barrel at one point, though it softened

DON'T USE MOBILE PHONE WHILE DRIVING



With the advent of mobile phones, life has really changed. People are getting connected with one another thanks to them but there is still some harm in using them when you must focus on something else at hand.

When you drive, it is important to pay attention and focus on the road ahead. If your senses are focused elsewhere (in this case: on using your phone), then there can be disastrous consequences for not only you, but also for other drivers around you.

The risks associated with using your phone or texting while driving have been publicized time and again. Numerous accidents have occurred solely because people were distracted by their gadgets.

Now we understand that staying in touch is important, but there's a safe way for you to be connected. Most modern cars, including Hyundai cars, come with sophisticated Bluetooth enabled infotainment systems so you

can communicate wirelessly through your mobile phone.

While texting on the move is definitely not recommended, voice commands can be used to make phone calls. Most Hyundai cars are also equipped with steering mounted controls to receive or reject calls while driving. This is a great way to stay connected and drive safely too. However, we still recommend that you keep the calls short so that you're not distracted and your focus is entirely on the road.

Even motorcyclists can safely have phone conversations with innovative Bluetooth devices that can be mounted on helmets. Using Bluetooth, these devices seamlessly connect to the mobile phone and allow bikers to answer or decline phone calls while on the go. No modifications are needed to install these devices.

Needless to say, today's technology provides you with a plethora of safety measures. So, use them and invest in them as they are truly life savers.

